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CUET UG

General Aptitude Test

# General Knowledge, Current Affairs & Static GK

Official Syllabus · General Test (Section III) · Class 12 · CUET UG 2027 Cycle Notes

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## Syllabus Alignment

| Sub-topic | Official Syllabus Pointer (NTA CUET GAT 501) | Core Skills Tested |
|---|---|---|
| **Static GK Pillars** | Static General Knowledge: Indian Constitution, Polity, Geography, History, Culture & Heritage. | Article-mandate matching, institutional hierarchy, geographical features, classical art forms. |
| **Current Affairs & Events** | Significant national and international events: Summits, treaties, geopolitical developments. | Tracking temporal milestones, summit hosts, international pacts, multilateral memberships. |
| **Global Institutions** | International organizations: UN specialized agencies, Bretton Woods, regional groupings. | Headquarters identification, founding charters, executive heads, functional mandates. |
| **Science & Milestones** | Science and defense breakthroughs: Space exploration (ISRO), defense acquisitions, Nobel prizes. | Mission objectives, launch vehicles, scientific discoveries, defense technology indigenous systems. |
| **Awards, Days & Books** | The Classic Trio: National awards, commemorative days, renowned historical books and authors. | Civilian/military award pyramids, commemorative dates, seminal historical literature attribution. |

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**EXAM PATTERN**

**CUET UG 2027 Official Exam Pattern:** The General Test (Section III, Code 501) presents **50 compulsory multiple-choice questions** to be attempted in **60 minutes**. Each correct response yields +5 marks, while an incorrect response incurs a −1 mark negative deduction (unattempted questions earn 0). General Knowledge and Current Affairs comprises approximately **15 to 20 questions** of the examination. Because GK items require zero computation, each question should be dispatched in **15 to 25 seconds**, preserving time for reasoning and numerical ability.

## The Three Structural Zones of General Knowledge

General Knowledge in competitive entrance examinations is frequently perceived as an unmanageable ocean of disconnected facts. In pedagogical reality, the curriculum partitions into three well-defined cognitive zones:

- **Static GK (The Permanent Bedrock):** Enduring institutional and factual architecture that remains unchanged across examination cycles (e.g., Constitutional Articles, mountain ranges, classical dance forms, international agency headquarters).
- **Dynamic Current Affairs (The Annual Narrative):** Major geopolitical summits, legislative enactments, environmental pacts, scientific missions, and sporting tournaments occurring across the trailing 12 months.

- **Everyday Civic and Scientific Literacy:** Practical common-sense understanding of democratic institutions, ecological conservation, technological systems, and foundational physical principles.

**THE BOTANICAL GARDEN ANALOGY**

Preparing for General Knowledge is identical to **cultivating a formal botanical garden**. Static GK represents the mature, deep-rooted banyan and teak trees—once planted in structured tables and watered through periodic revision, they endure permanently. Current Affairs represents the seasonal flowering beds—cultivated continuously through daily 15-minute news logs and pruned before the exam. Everyday Knowledge is the ambient climate: an instinctive curiosity regarding how society and technology function.

# Indian Constitutional Architecture & Governance

The Indian Constitution, adopted on **26 November 1949** and enforced on **26 January 1950**, serves as the fundamental legal charter of the Republic. It is the longest written national constitution in human history.

## The Preamble: Ideological Compass

The Preamble encapsulates the fundamental values and philosophical vision of the Constitution:

- **Core Declaration:** Identifies the people of India as the ultimate source of sovereign authority (**"We, the People of India..."**).
- **The Quintuple Attributes:** India is declared a **Sovereign, Socialist, Secular, Democratic, Republic**.
- **The 42nd Constitutional Amendment Act (1976):** The historic amendment that inserted three crucial words into the Preamble: **Socialist, Secular,** and **Integrity**.

## Fundamental Rights (Part III, Articles 12–35)

Regarded as the "Magna Carta of India," Fundamental Rights are legally enforceable (justiciable) through the courts:

- **Right to Equality (Articles 14–18):** Equality before law (Art 14); prohibition of discrimination on grounds of religion, race, caste, sex, or place of birth (Art 15); equality of opportunity in public employment (Art 16); abolition of untouchability (Art 17); abolition of titles (Art 18).
- **Right to Freedom (Articles 19–22):** Six democratic freedoms (speech, peaceful assembly, association, movement, residence, profession — Art 19); protection in respect of conviction for offences (Art 20); **Right to Life and Personal Liberty (Article 21)**; Right to Education (Article 21A, added by the 86th Amendment Act, 2002).
- **Right Against Exploitation (Articles 23–24):** Prohibition of human trafficking and forced labor (Art 23); prohibition of employment of children in factories and hazardous labor (Art 24).
- **Right to Freedom of Religion (Articles 25–28):** Freedom of conscience and profession, practice, and propagation of religion.
- **Cultural and Educational Rights (Articles 29–30):** Protection of linguistic and religious minority interests and administration of educational institutions.
- **Right to Constitutional Remedies (Article 32):** Termed by Dr. B.R. Ambedkar as the **"Heart and Soul of the Constitution."** Empowers citizens to petition the Supreme Court directly for the enforcement of Fundamental Rights via five prerogative writs:

1. **Habeas Corpus:** "To have the body" — commands the physical release of an unlawfully detained individual.
2. **Mandamus:** "We command" — directs a public official or body to perform a mandatory statutory duty.
3. **Prohibition:** Issued by a superior court to prevent an inferior tribunal from exceeding jurisdiction.
4. **Certiorari:** "To be certified" — quashes an order passed by a lower court in excess of jurisdiction.
5. **Quo Warranto:** "By what authority" — challenges an individual's legal claim to hold a public office.

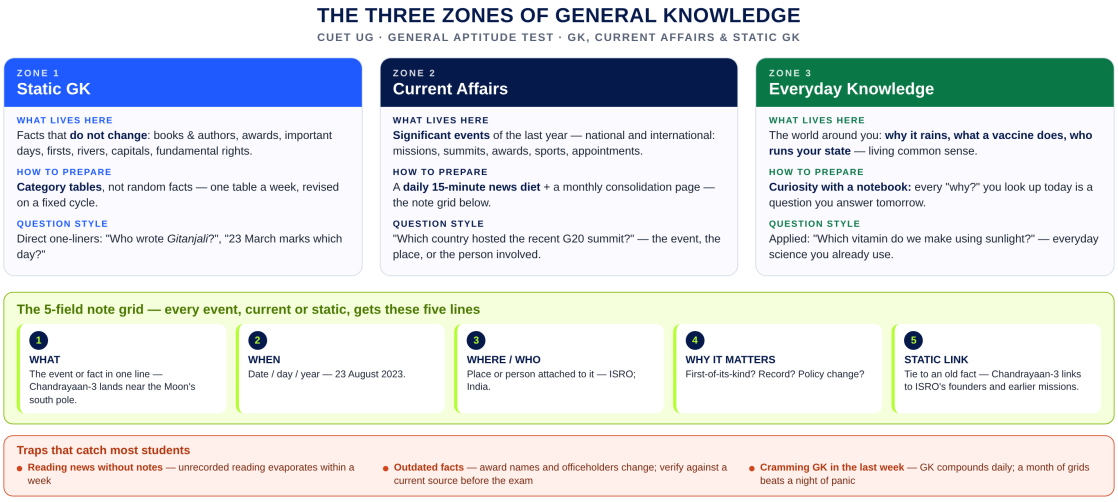



Figure 1: The Three Zones of General Knowledge: Differentiating Static Bedrock, Dynamic Current Affairs, and Everyday Knowledge, bound by the 5-Field Event Deconstruction Framework.

## Directive Principles of State Policy & Fundamental Duties

- **DPSP (Part IV, Articles 36–51):** Borrowed from the Irish Constitution. Non-justiciable moral guidelines commanding the state to establish socio-economic democracy and a welfare state (e.g., Uniform Civil Code — Article 44; Organization of village panchayats — Article 40; Protection of environment and forests — Article 48A).
- **Fundamental Duties (Part IVA, Article 51A):** Incorporated via the 42nd Amendment Act (1976) based on the recommendations of the **Swaran Singh Committee**, inspired by the USSR Constitution. Originally 10 duties; the 11th duty (obligation of parents to provide education to children aged 6–14) was added by the 86th Amendment Act (2002).

## High-Frequency Constitutional and Statutory Bodies

- **Election Commission of India (Article 324):** Independent constitutional authority administering elections to Parliament, State Legislatures, and the offices of President and Vice President.
- **Comptroller and Auditor General of India (CAG, Article 148):** Guardian of the public purse; audits all receipts and expenditure of the Government of India and the states.
- **Union Public Service Commission (UPSC, Article 315):** Central recruitment authority.
- **Finance Commission (Article 280):** Constituted every five years by the President to recommend tax distribution between the Union and the States.

- **Statutory Bodies (Created by Act of Parliament):** National Human Rights Commission (NHRC, 1993), National Commission for Women (NCW, 1992).
- **Executive Body (Non-Constitutional, Non-Statutory): NITI Aayog** (National Institution for Transforming India), established via cabinet resolution on **1 January 2015**, replacing the erstwhile Planning Commission.

### Emergency Provisions (Part XVIII)

- **National Emergency (Article 352):** Proclaimed on grounds of war, external aggression, or armed rebellion. Articles 20 and 21 cannot be suspended during a National Emergency.
- **President's Rule / State Emergency (Article 356):** Imposed when governance in a state cannot be carried on in accordance with constitutional provisions.
- **Financial Emergency (Article 360):** Proclaimed if financial stability or credit of India is threatened. Notably, **Article 360 has never been invoked in India's history**.

## International Organizations & Multilateral Blocs

CUET questions rigorously evaluate candidate mastery over international institutions, specialized agencies, and strategic alliances:

| Organization | Headquarters | Established | Core Mandate & Strategic Purpose |
|---|---|---|---|
| United Nations (UN) | New York, USA | 1945 | Global peace, collective security; 6 principal organs (ICJ at The Hague). |
| UNESCO | Paris, France | 1945 | Educational, scientific, and cultural heritage preservation (World Heritage Sites). |
| WHO | Geneva, Switzerland | 1948 | Global public health, disease surveillance, pandemic coordination. |
| IMF | Washington, D.C., USA | 1944 | International financial stability, balance of payments support (Bretton Woods). |
| World Bank (IBRD) | Washington, D.C., USA | 1944 | Long-term developmental reconstruction loans and poverty alleviation. |
| WTO | Geneva, Switzerland | 1995 | Governs global trade agreements, tariffs, dispute settlement (replaced GATT). |
| BRICS | Secretariat: Rotating | 2009/2010 | Major emerging economies (Brazil, Russia, India, China, South Africa + 2024 members). |
| G20 | Secretariat: Rotating | 1999 | Premier forum for international economic cooperation; India held 2023 Presidency. |
| ASEAN | Jakarta, Indonesia | 1967 | Economic, political, and security cooperation among 10 Southeast Asian states. |

| Organization | Headquarters | Established | Core Mandate & Strategic Purpose |
|---|---|---|---|
| SCO | Beijing, China | 2001 | Eurasian political, economic, and security alliance; India became full member in 2017. |




Figure 2: Comprehensive architectural matrix of General Knowledge: Synthesizing constitutional pillars, international institutions, cultural heritage anchors, and the 4-step GK answering protocol.

# Indian Physical Geography and Cultural Heritage

## Indian Physical Superlatives & River Systems

- **The Himalayan Mountain Arc:** Formed by tectonic collision of the Indian and Eurasian plates.
  - **Mount Everest (8,848.86 m):** World's highest peak (located in Nepal/Tibet).
  - **K2 / Godwin Austen (8,611 m):** Second-highest peak on Earth (in Karakoram range, PoK).
  - **Kanchenjunga (8,586 m):** Highest mountain peak located **within undisputed Indian territory** (Sikkim border).
- **Drainage Networks:**
  - **Ganga (2,525 km):** Longest river flowing within India, originating as Bhagirathi from Gangotri glacier (Gaumukh).
  - **Godavari (1,465 km):** Known as **"Dakshin Ganga"** or **"Vridha Ganga"**; longest peninsular river in India.
  - **Brahmaputra:** Originates in Tibet as the **Yarlung Tsangpo**, enters India through Arunachal Pradesh as Dihang, joins the Ganga in Bangladesh as the Padma and Meghna.
  - **West-Flowing Rivers: Narmada** and **Tapi** flow through fault rift valleys into the Arabian Sea, forming estuaries rather than deltas.

## The Eight Classical Dances of India

Officially recognized by the **Sangeet Natak Akademi** (India's National Academy for Music, Dance and Drama):

| Classical Dance | State of Origin | Key Aesthetic Features & Thematic Roots |
|---|---|---|
| Bharatanatyam | Tamil Nadu | Oldest classical dance tradition; characterized by sculpted poses, crisp footwork, and temple devadasis roots. |
| Kathak | Uttar Pradesh / North India | Storytelling tradition (**katha**); famous for intricate rhythmic footwork (**tatkar**) and rapid pirouettes (**chakkars**). |
| Kathakali | Kerala | Dance-drama featuring elaborate facial makeup, towering headgear (**kireetam**), and dramatic mythological narratives. |
| Mohiniyattam | Kerala | Dance of the enchantress (**Mohini**); graceful, swaying feminine movements with golden-bordered white attire. |
| Odissi | Odisha | Distinguished by the sensual **Tribhanga** posture (three-bend body pose) and temple sculptures aesthetic. |
| Kuchipudi | Andhra Pradesh | Combines energetic dance with spoken dialogue and brass plate balancing (**Tarangam**). |
| Manipuri | Manipur | Gentle, lyrical movements depicting Vaishnavite devotional themes (**Raas Leela**); distinctive barrel skirt (**Kumil**). |
| Sattriya | Assam | Created in the 15th century by Vaishnavite saint-reformer **Srimanta Sankardev** inside monastic centers (**Sattras**). |

## Prominent National Parks and Biosphere Reserves

- **Jim Corbett National Park (Uttarakhand):** India's oldest national park (established in 1936 as Hailey National Park); launch site of Project Tiger (1973).
- **Kaziranga National Park (Assam):** UNESCO World Heritage Site hosting two-thirds of the world's Great One-Horned Rhinoceroses.
- **Sundarbans National Park (West Bengal):** World's largest mangrove forest delta; home of the Royal Bengal Tiger.
- **Gir National Park (Gujarat):** The sole surviving wild sanctuary for the Asiatic Lion (**Panthera leo persica**).
- **Keibul Lamjao National Park (Manipur):** The world's only **floating national park**, situated upon Loktak Lake, preserving the endangered Sangai brow-antlered deer on floating vegetation masses (**phumdis**).

# Science, Defense, and Modern Milestones

## The Indian Space Exploration Architecture (ISRO)

Headquartered in Bengaluru (established on **15 August 1969** under Dr. Vikram Sarabhai):

- **Chandrayaan-3 (2023):** Historic lunar mission comprising the **Vikram lander** and **Pragyan rover**. On **23 August 2023**, India became the first nation to achieve a successful soft-landing near the lunar south pole. The landing site was officially named **"Shiv Shakti Point"**, and 23 August was declared **National Space Day**.
- **Aditya-L1 (2023):** India's first dedicated space-based observatory placed into a halo orbit around the Sun-Earth **Lagrangian Point 1 (L1)** to study solar flares, coronal mass ejections, and the solar corona.
- **Gaganyaan Program:** India's flagship human spaceflight mission aiming to demonstrate indigenous crewed orbital capability in low Earth orbit.

## Strategic Defense & Indigenous Missiles (DRDO)

Developed largely under the Integrated Guided Missile Development Programme (IGMDP) spearheaded by Dr. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam:

- **PRITHVI:** Surface-to-surface short-range ballistic missile.
- **AGNI:** Surface-to-surface medium to intercontinental ballistic missile series (Agni-V with range $> 5,000$ km).
- **TRISHUL / AKASH:** Surface-to-air defense missile systems.
- **NAG:** Third-generation "fire-and-forget" anti-tank guided missile.
- **BRAHMOS:** Supersonic cruise missile jointly developed by India (DRDO) and Russia (NPO Mashinostroyeniya), capable of land, sea, sub-sea, and air launches.

## The Award Pyramid of the Republic of India

- **Civilian Honours:** Instituted in 1954:
  1. **Bharat Ratna:** Highest civilian honour (first recipients in 1954: C. Rajagopalachari, Dr. S. Radhakrishnan, Dr. C.V. Raman).
  2. **Padma Vibhushan:** For exceptional and distinguished service.
  3. **Padma Bhushan:** For distinguished service of a high order.
  4. **Padma Shri:** For distinguished service in any field.
- **Military Gallantry Honours (Wartime vs Peacetime):**
  - **Wartime Gallantry: Param Vir Chakra (PVC)** (Highest military decoration; first recipient Major Somnath Sharma) → Maha Vir Chakra → Vir Chakra.
  - **Peacetime Gallantry: Ashok Chakra** (Highest peacetime bravery award) → Kirti Chakra → Shaurya Chakra.

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## Chronology of the Indian Freedom Movement

CUET GAT questions frequently target pivotal chronological milestones and leadership anchors of modern Indian history:

| Year | Historical Landmark | Strategic Context & National Impact |
|---|---|---|
| 1857 | First War of Independence / Revolt of 1857 | Uprising against East India Company rule; led to direct British Crown takeover under the Government of India Act 1858. |
| 1885 | Founding of Indian National Congress | Founded in Bombay by retired British civil servant Allan Octavian Hume; Womesh Chandra Bonnerjee was the inaugural President. |
| 1905 | Partition of Bengal & Swadeshi Movement | Enacted by Viceroy Lord Curzon; catalyzed the Swadeshi and Boycott movement; partitioned Bengal along communal lines. |
| 1915 | Return of Mahatma Gandhi | Gandhi returned to India from South Africa on **9 January 1915** (celebrated annually as **Pravasi Bharatiya Divas**). |
| 1919 | Jallianwala Bagh Massacre | British troops under General Reginald Dyer opened fire on unarmed gathering in Amritsar on **13 April 1919** (Baisakhi). Rabindranath Tagore renounced his knighthood. |
| 1920–22 | Non-Cooperation Movement | Mass struggle launched under Gandhi's leadership; abruptly halted following the **Chauri Chaura** police station arson in Gorakhpur in Feb 1922. |
| 1929 | Lahore Congress Session & Purna Swaraj | Presided over by Jawaharlal Nehru; passed the historic resolution for complete independence (**Purna Swaraj**); 26 Jan 1930 marked as first Independence Day. |
| 1930 | Dandi March & Civil Disobedience | Gandhi led 78 followers from Sabarmati Ashram to Dandi (240 miles) from 12 March to 6 April 1930 to manufacture salt in defiance of colonial monopoly. |
| 1932 | Poona Pact | Agreement between Dr. B.R. Ambedkar and Mahatma Gandhi in Yerwada Jail; provided reserved legislative seats for depressed classes instead of separate electorates. |
| 1942 | Quit India Movement | Launched at Bombay's Gowalia Tank Maidan on **8 August 1942**; Gandhi delivered the historic clarion call: **"Do or Die"** (**Karo ya Maro**). |
| 1946 | Cabinet Mission Plan | Arrived to formulate constitution-making machinery; laid the framework for the election of the Constituent Assembly. |

## Global Environmental Conventions & Ecological Pacts

Environmental accords and conservation frameworks are a major staple of the CUET General Test:

| Accord / Treaty | Adopted (City) | Core Mandate & Global Governance Objective |
|---|---|---|
| Ramsar Convention | 1971 (Ramsar, Iran) | Conservation and sustainable utilization of international wetlands. Chilika Lake (Odisha) and Keoladeo (Rajasthan) were India's first designated sites. |
| Stockholm Conference | 1972 (Sweden) | First major UN conference on human environment; catalyzed the establishment of the United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP, HQ Nairobi). |
| Montreal Protocol | 1987 (Canada) | Global multilateral treaty protecting the stratospheric ozone layer by systematically phasing out ozone-depleting chlorofluorocarbons (CFCs). Highly successful. |
| Rio Earth Summit (UNCED) | 1992 (Brazil) | Historic conference producing **Agenda 21**, the Convention on Biological Diversity (CBD), and the UN Framework Convention on Climate Change (UNFCCC). |
| Kyoto Protocol | 1997 (Japan) | Legally binding emissions reduction targets on industrialized nations (Annex I) to curb greenhouse gases; introduced carbon credit mechanisms. |
| Paris Agreement (COP21) | 2015 (France) | Global pact aiming to limit global temperature rise to well below 2.0°C above pre-industrial levels, pursuing efforts toward 1.5°C threshold. |
| International Solar Alliance (ISA) | 2015 (Paris/India) | Joint initiative launched by India and France to mobilize solar deployment across tropical states; Headquarters located in **Gurugram, Haryana, India**. |

## Nobel Laureates of Indian Origin & National Scientific Pioneers

India has contributed seminal discoveries across physics, chemistry, medicine, and economics recognized by the Nobel Foundation:

| Laureate | Year | Field | Key Scientific / Humanitarian Contribution |
|---|---|---|---|
| Rabindranath Tagore | 1913 | Literature | Lyric poetry anthology **Gitanjali**; first non-European and Asian Nobel laureate. |
| Sir C.V. Raman | 1930 | Physics | Discovery of the **Raman Effect** (inelastic scattering of photon light particles); National Science Day (28 Feb). |
| Har Gobind Khorana | 1968 | Medicine | Deciphering the genetic code and its function in protein synthesis (co-recipient). |

| Laureate | Year | Field | Key Scientific / Humanitarian Contribution |
|---|---|---|---|
| Mother Teresa | 1979 | Peace | Humanitarian service for the poorest of the poor through the Missionaries of Charity. |
| Subrahmanyan Chandrasekhar | 1983 | Physics | Theoretical studies on physical structure of stars (**Chandrasekhar Limit** = 1.44 solar masses). |
| Amartya Sen | 1998 | Economics | Contributions to welfare economics, social choice theory, poverty indices, and famine prevention. |
| Venkatraman Ramakrishnan | 2009 | Chemistry | Studies of the atomic structure and function of the ribosome (cellular protein factory). |
| Kailash Satyarthi | 2014 | Peace | Struggle against suppression of child labor through **Bachpan Bachao Andolan** (co-awarded with Malala Yousafzai). |
| Abhijit Banerjee | 2019 | Economics | Experimental approach to alleviating global poverty through Randomized Controlled Trials (RCTs). |

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# Chapter Synthesis & Cognitive Mindmap




Figure 3: Comprehensive architectural mindmap of General Knowledge & Current Affairs: Synthesizing constitutional pillars, international bodies, cultural heritage, scientific milestones, and the 5-field event protocol.

## HIGH-YIELD MEMORY HOOKS FOR CUET 2027 GAT GK

Keep these fundamental factual anchors and decision rules primed:

- **Constitutional Remedies:** Article 32 is the “Heart & Soul”; High Courts issue writs under Article 226.
- **Preamble Additions:** 42nd Amendment (1976) added **Socialist, Secular, and Integrity**.
- **Bretton Woods Twins:** IMF and World Bank are both headquartered in **Washington, D.C.**.
- **World vs India Peak:** Mount Everest is the world’s highest (Nepal); Kanchenjunga is India’s highest undisputed peak.
- **Civilian vs Military Peak:** Bharat Ratna is civilian; Param Vir Chakra is wartime military. Never swap them!
- **Floating National Park:** Keibul Lamjao on Loktak Lake, Manipur (Sangai deer).
- **National Space Day: August 23**, commemorating Chandrayaan-3′s lunar south pole soft landing.

## MASTER STRATEGY CHEATSHEET — GENERAL KNOWLEDGE & CURRENT AFFAIRS

**1. Constitutional Quick Index:**

- **Part III (Fundamental Rights):** Articles 14–32 (Enforceable/Justiciable).
- **Part IV (DPSP):** Articles 36–51 (Non-justiciable; Art 44 = Uniform Civil Code).
- **Part IVA (Fundamental Duties):** Article 51A (11 duties; 42nd & 86th Amendments).
- **Part XVIII (Emergencies):** Art 352 (National), Art 356 (President's Rule), Art 360 (Financial — never used).

**2. UN & Global Agency Locations:**

- **New York:** UN Headquarters, UNICEF.
- **Geneva:** WHO, WTO, ILO, UNHCR, WIPO.
- **Paris:** UNESCO, OECD.
- **Washington, D.C.:** World Bank, IMF.
- **The Hague:** International Court of Justice (ICJ).
- **Rome:** Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO), World Food Programme (WFP).

**3. The 5-Field Daily Event Deconstruction Grid:**

Event → WHAT (Core) + WHEN (Date) + WHERE / WHO (Agency) + WHY (Significance) + STATIC LINK

## THE SEVEN FATAL CUET TRAPS IN GENERAL KNOWLEDGE

1. **The Head of State vs Head of Government Confusion:** Mistaking the President (Head of the State / Constitutional Head) for the Prime Minister (Head of the Government / Executive Head).
2. **The Article 32 vs Article 226 Jurisdiction Slip:** Forgetting that Supreme Court writ jurisdiction is under Article 32 (only for Fundamental Rights), while High Courts issue writs under Article 226 (for Fundamental Rights and other legal rights).
3. **The Geographical Superlative Misplacement:** Confusing K2 (in PoK/Karakoram) with Kanchenjunga (the highest mountain peak in undisputed Indian territory).
4. **The Award Pyramid Category Swap:** Choosing Bharat Ratna as a sports or military award. Bharat Ratna is India's highest civilian honour; Major Dhyan Chand Khel Ratna is highest for sports; Param Vir Chakra is highest for military gallantry.
5. **The Classical Dance Origin Scramble:** Confusing Kathakali (Kerala dance-drama) with Kathak (North Indian classical dance), or Mohiniyattam (Kerala) with Kuchipudi (Andhra Pradesh).
6. **The Bretton Woods vs UN Headquarters Swap:** Stating Geneva or New York as headquarters of the IMF/World Bank instead of Washington, D.C.
7. **The Blind Guessing Negative Penalty:** Wildly guessing on obscure factual questions. If you cannot eliminate at least two options, leave the question unattempted to shield your score against the −1 deduction.

# Practice Questions — Part 1: Polity & Constitution (Q1 to Q5)

**Q1.** Which Constitutional Amendment Act added the terms "Socialist", "Secular", and "Integrity" to the Preamble of the Constitution of India?

(A) 44th Constitutional Amendment Act, 1978
(B) 42nd Constitutional Amendment Act, 1976
(C) 86th Constitutional Amendment Act, 2002
(D) 73rd Constitutional Amendment Act, 1992

**Sol. Q1.** The 42nd Constitutional Amendment Act of 1976 (frequently termed the "Mini-Constitution") inserted the words **Socialist, Secular,** and **Integrity** into the Preamble. The 44th Amendment restored civil liberties post-emergency; the 86th added Article 21A (Education); the 73rd constitutionalized Panchayati Raj. **Answer: (B)**

**Q2.** Which article of the Indian Constitution was characterized by Dr. B.R. Ambedkar as the "very soul of the Constitution and the very heart of it"?

(A) Article 14 (Equality before Law)
(B) Article 19 (Right to Freedom)
(C) Article 21 (Protection of Life and Personal Liberty)
(D) Article 32 (Right to Constitutional Remedies)

**Sol. Q2.** Dr. B.R. Ambedkar designated Article 32 (Right to Constitutional Remedies) as the "Heart and Soul" of the Constitution because without legal remedies to enforce Fundamental Rights via judicial writs, fundamental guarantees would be rendered meaningless. **Answer: (D)**

**Q3.** Which of the following bodies in India is an EXECUTIVE body created via Cabinet Resolution, and NOT a constitutional or statutory authority?

(A) Election Commission of India
(B) NITI Aayog
(C) Comptroller and Auditor General of India
(D) Union Public Service Commission

**Sol. Q3.** NITI Aayog (National Institution for Transforming India) was constituted on 1 January 2015 via an executive resolution of the Union Cabinet, replacing the Planning Commission. The Election Commission (Art 324), CAG (Art 148), and UPSC (Art 315) are established directly by the Constitution. **Answer: (B)**

**Q4.** Under the Indian Constitution, which Fundamental Rights CANNOT be suspended even during the proclamation of a National Emergency under Article 352?

(A) Article 20 and Article 21
(B) Article 19 and Article 20
(C) Article 14 and Article 19
(D) Article 21 and Article 22

**Sol. Q4.** By virtue of the 44th Constitutional Amendment Act (1978), the right to protection in respect of conviction for offences (**Article 20**) and the right to life and personal liberty (**Article 21**) cannot be suspended under any circumstances, including a National Emergency under Article 352 (Option A). **Answer: (A)**

**Q5.** The Fundamental Duties of Indian citizens were incorporated into Part IVA of the Constitution based on the recommendations of which committee?

(A) Sarkaria Commission
(B) Verma Committee
(C) Swaran Singh Committee
(D) Kothari Commission

**Sol. Q5.** The Swaran Singh Committee was appointed by the Union Government in 1976 to assess constitutional amendments, and its recommendations directly resulted in the insertion of Fundamental Duties (Article 51A) via the 42nd Amendment Act. Sarkaria examined Center-State relations; Kothari addressed education reform. **Answer: (C)**

# Practice Questions — Part 2: Global Institutions & Geography (Q6 to Q10)

**Q6.** The International Court of Justice (ICJ), the principal judicial organ of the United Nations, has its seat located in:

(A) Geneva, Switzerland
(B) New York, USA
(C) The Hague, Netherlands
(D) Vienna, Austria

**Sol. Q6.** Among the six principal organs of the United Nations, the International Court of Justice (ICJ) is the only organ situated outside New York; its permanent seat is located at the Peace Palace in The Hague, Netherlands. Geneva hosts WHO and WTO; Vienna hosts IAEA. **Answer: (C)**

**Q7.** Both the International Monetary Fund (IMF) and the International Bank for Reconstruction and Development (World Bank) were established following the 1944 conference held at:

(A) Bretton Woods, New Hampshire, USA
(B) San Francisco, California, USA
(C) Yalta, Crimea
(D) Potsdam, Germany

**Sol. Q7.** The IMF and World Bank were conceived at the United Nations Monetary and Financial Conference held in July 1944 at Bretton Woods, New Hampshire, earning them the moniker the "Bretton Woods Twins." Both institutions maintain headquarters in Washington, D.C. **Answer: (A)**

**Q8.** Which of the following mountain peaks represents the highest mountain summit located within undisputed Indian territory?

(A) Mount Everest
(B) K2 (Godwin-Austen)
(C) Nanda Devi
(D) Kanchenjunga

**Sol. Q8.** Kanchenjunga (8,586 m), situated along the Sikkim-Nepal border, is the highest peak located within undisputed Indian borders. Mount Everest (8,848 m) lies in Nepal; K2 (8,611 m) lies in the Karakoram range in Pakistan-occupied Kashmir (PoK); Nanda Devi (7,816 m) is entirely within India but lower. **Answer: (D)**

**Q9.** The world's only floating national park, Keibul Lamjao National Park, famous for preserving the endangered brow-antlered deer (Sangai), is situated in which Indian state?

(A) Assam
(B) Manipur
(C) Meghalaya
(D) Mizoram

**Sol. Q9.** Keibul Lamjao National Park is situated on Loktak Lake in the Bishnupur district of Manipur. It is characterized by floating decomposing plant biomass termed **phumdis**, providing the exclusive wild habitat for the endangered Eld's deer subspecies (**Sangai**). **Answer: (B)**

**Q10.** Which peninsular Indian river is famously designated as "Dakshin Ganga" due to its extensive basin, spiritual reverence, and length?

(A) Krishna
(B) Cauvery
(C) Godavari
(D) Mahanadi

**Sol. Q10.** The Godavari River (1,465 km) is the longest river in Peninsular India and second longest in India after the Ganga; because of its vast size, age, and spiritual sanctity, it is termed **Dakshin Ganga** (Ganges of the South). Cauvery is sometimes referred to as the Ganga of the South due to ritual holiness, but Godavari is the official geographical Dakshin Ganga. **Answer: (C)**

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# Practice Questions — Part 3: Culture, Science & Awards (Q11 to Q15)

**Q11.** Sattriya, one of the eight classical dance forms of India recognized by the Sangeet Natak Akademi, originated in which state as an integral part of the Bhakti movement?

(A) Odisha (B) Manipur
(C) Assam (D) Tripura

**Sol. Q11.** Sattriya originated in the 15th century in Assam, propagated by the revered Vaishnavite scholar, poet, and saint-reformer **Srimanta Sankardev** inside Vaishnava monasteries known as **Sattras**. It was officially designated a classical dance by the Sangeet Natak Akademi in 2000. **Answer: (C)**

**Q12.** On which date is National Space Day celebrated annually in India to commemorate the historic soft-landing of the Chandrayaan-3 lander on the Moon?

(A) 14 July (B) 23 August
(C) 2 September (D) 22 October

**Sol. Q12.** The Government of India declared **23 August** as **National Space Day** to commemorate the triumphant soft-landing of Chandrayaan-3's Vikram lander near the lunar south pole on 23 August 2023, making India the fourth nation to land on the Moon and first in the polar region. **Answer: (B)**

**Q13.** Who among the following was NOT among the first three recipients of India's highest civilian honour, the Bharat Ratna, when it was instituted in 1954?

(A) C. Rajagopalachari (B) Dr. S. Radhakrishnan
(C) Dr. C.V. Raman (D) Jawaharlal Nehru

**Sol. Q13.** In 1954, the inaugural Bharat Ratna was conferred upon three eminent citizens: C. Rajagopalachari (last Governor-General of India), Dr. Sarvepalli Radhakrishnan (first Vice President), and Dr. C.V. Raman (Nobel laureate physicist). Jawaharlal Nehru was awarded the Bharat Ratna later in 1955. **Answer: (D)**

**Q14.** Aditya-L1, India's premier dedicated scientific space observatory, was launched by ISRO to study solar dynamics from a halo orbit around which point?

(A) Sun-Earth Lagrangian Point 1 (L1) (B) Earth-Moon Lagrangian Point 1 (L1)
(C) Sun-Earth Lagrangian Point 2 (L2) (D) Geostationary Transfer Orbit

**Sol. Q14.** Aditya-L1 was positioned in a halo orbit around the Sun-Earth **Lagrangian Point 1 (L1)**, situated roughly 1.5 million kilometers from Earth. This location affords an uninterrupted, continuous view of the Sun without occultation or eclipses. **Answer: (A)**

**Q15.** The premier literary award in India, the Jnanpith Award, instituted in 1961, was first conferred in 1965 upon which renowned writer?

(A) Rabindranath Tagore (B) G. Sankara Kurup
(C) Munshi Premchand (D) K.V. Puttappa (Kuvempu)

**Sol. Q15.** The inaugural Jnanpith Award was conferred in 1965 upon celebrated Malayalam poet **G. Sankara Kurup** for his poetry anthology **Odakkuzhal** (The Bamboo Flute). Tagore won the Nobel in 1913; Premchand passed away in 1936 before Jnanpith was founded. **Answer: (B)**